Plan 1: A Saturday out in London

Start: London Bridge station at 10:00 · 4 stops, including lunch
Costs: about £7.50 for food and entry, plus about £6 transport

1. 10:11–10:36 St Dunstan-in-the-East: a ruined church garden hidden in the City

Getting there: about 11 min on foot from London Bridge station.
Walk down St Dunstan's Hill towards the river.
Among office blocks, you walk into the ruins of a medieval church that is now a public garden.
Cost: free
If it rains: Graze your way round Borough Market, about 15 min away on foot.

2. 10:47–11:22 The Garden at 120: a rooftop garden among the City towers

Getting there: about 6 min on foot from St Dunstan-in-the-East.
Go into Hogarth Court from Fenchurch Street or Fenchurch Avenue, pass an airport-style security check, and take the lift to floor 15.
You step out 15 floors up into a garden of wisteria, roses and hydrangeas around a water feature, with the City's towers all around and views to the Thames and Tower Bridge.
Cost: free

3. 11:54–12:36 Beigel Bake: a salt beef bagel on Brick Lane

Getting there: about 22 min: walk to Bank, Monument or Fenchurch Street station, then take the Tube or bus to Liverpool Street or Aldgate East station.
Walk up Brick Lane to number 159.
You queue at a counter that never closes and eat a hot salt beef bagel with mustard on the pavement.
Allow about 10 min to queue.
Food: about £7.50

4. 13:18–14:26 Canal steps and Coal Drops Yard at King's Cross

Getting there: about 32 min: walk to Liverpool Street or Aldgate East station, then take the Tube or bus to King's Cross St Pancras station.
Walk north from the station up King's Boulevard to Granary Square.
You sit on the wide steps down to Regent's Canal, walk through the fountains in Granary Square, and wander under the curved roofs of Coal Drops Yard, among the new tech offices.
Cost: free